The Structure of Creation — Five Stages

From Field to Bundle

2026-10-23

Contents

The Structure of Creation — Five Stages **2**
- What This Is . . . 2
- The Five Stages . . . 2
- Why We Get Stuck in the Middle . . . 3
- What This Is Useful For . . . 4
- Evidence and Limitations . . . 4

The Structure of Creation — Five Stages

What This Is

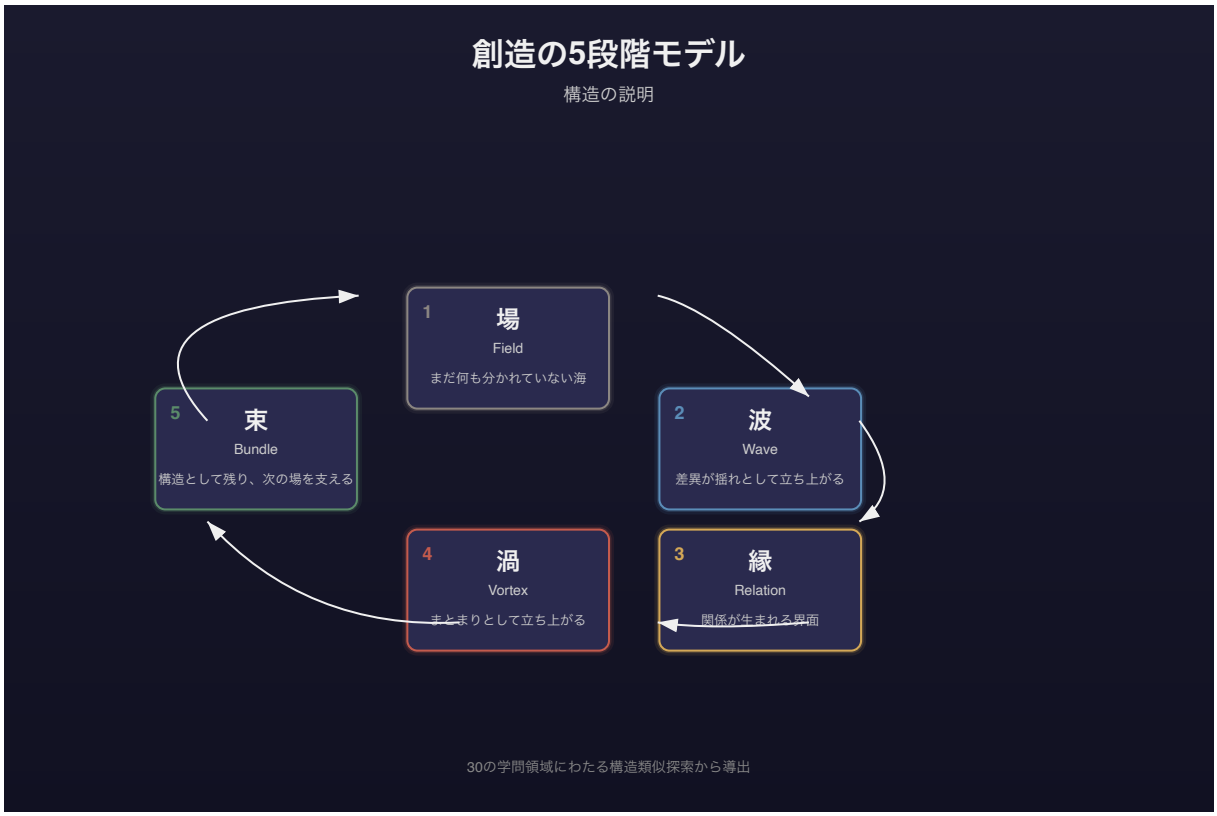


Figure 1: The 5-Stage Model of Creation — Structural Overview

This document describes a model of the structure common to creation.

If we think of creation as "the ability to come up with good ideas," we end up talking about something we cannot observe. Here, we take a different perspective. We describe creation as a transformation from one state to another. This transformation has five stages: Field, Wave, Relation, Vortex, and Bundle.

These five stages are not a set of instructions for "how to succeed." They are a structure for seeing "what is happening right now." When you are trying to make something and find yourself stuck, this model helps you distinguish whether something is broken or whether you are simply standing at a particular stage.

The Five Stages

Field — Nothing Has Arisen

Field is a state of nothing. Not even unease. No direction, no structure, not even the faintest sense that "something is off." It can be described as zero, as void.

From this "nothing," something will eventually emerge. The first faint stirring — a vague sense of "something is on my mind" — marks the beginning of the transition to the next stage (Wave). Field is before that. Complete stillness.

Wave — Multiple Directions Emerge

From within the unease, opposing directions begin to emerge. “Maybe this way.” “Or maybe that way.” An oscillation arises.

At the Wave stage, multiple directions exist simultaneously. The temptation is to settle on one quickly, but the role of this stage is to maintain the opposition. You carry the information contained in the tension forward to the next stage.

Relation — Contradictions Coexist

The oppositions born in the Wave stage can no longer be resolved by simple either/or choices. Contradictory elements exist simultaneously, refusing to converge in either direction. Relationships multiply. Complexity reaches its peak.

Relation is the most uncomfortable place in the five stages. It demands that you remain while holding contradictions. If you flee from this discomfort — by deciding quickly or starting over from scratch — the quality of what emerges in the next stage suffers.

Remaining in contradiction. Not resolving it immediately, but weaving relationships within it. This is the essence of the Relation stage.

Vortex — A New Coherence Emerges

From the contradictions held in the Relation stage, a new coherence spontaneously arises. Elements that were in opposition become integrated at a higher dimension. A structure that was previously invisible appears in an explicable form.

What matters at the Vortex stage is not to over-protect the emerging form. The Vortex is not yet a settled structure. Articulating the conditions under which this coherence holds — where it is valid and where it is not — supports the transition to the next stage.

Bundle — Stabilized as Structure

The coherence that arose in the Vortex stabilizes as a reusable structure. Direction is established, and a form that can be applied in other contexts remains.

The Bundle is not an endpoint. A stabilized structure becomes the starting point for the next unease. Returning from Bundle to Field — taking the completed structure as a given and letting a new “something is off” drift — is what sustains creation.

The five stages are not linear but cyclical.

If anything in this explanation so far feels off, that may be an important perspective related to the scope of this model. Holding that sense of unease while reading on, or pausing here, are both meaningful choices.

Why We Get Stuck in the Middle

Of the five stages, the one where teams often encounter difficulty is the Relation stage.

The reason is clear. At Relation, contradiction reaches its maximum. Choosing one side of the opposition would bring relief, but that means returning to the Wave stage. Starting over returns you to the Field, but the information accumulated so far is lost.

Remaining in contradiction is uncomfortable. But this discomfort has structural significance. While you remain at Relation, new relationships are being woven between the opposing elements.

This accumulation of relationships creates the conditions for the Vortex — the spontaneous emergence of new coherence.

Being stuck in the middle is not a malfunction. It means you are standing at a particular stage.

What This Is Useful For

What this model provides is a way to know "where you are right now."

When you are trying to make something and hit a wall, it is tempting to think "I lack talent" or "I don't have enough ideas." But from the perspective of the five stages, most blockages mean you are at the Relation stage. What you need is not talent or ideas, but time to remain in contradiction.

The five stages also help you judge "what to do now." At Field, don't rush to define. At Wave, maintain the opposition. At Relation, don't flee — weave relationships. At Vortex, articulate the conditions of the form. At Bundle, open yourself to the next unease.

The appropriate action differs by stage.

Evidence and Limitations

The five-stage structure was articulated by the author from lived experience. It has since been investigated across 30 academic domains to explore structural correspondences with established concepts in each field. In fields as diverse as complexity science, neuroscience, architecture, music, organizational theory, and anthropology, similar stage structures have been repeatedly observed. In particular, a stage where contradictions coexist (corresponding to Relation) has been consistently identified as playing a significant role in creation across many domains.

However, the following points remain at the hypothesis stage.

Whether the order of the five stages is universal has not been confirmed. Overlap between stages is considered possible. The extent to which individual differences, cultural differences, and domain differences affect the structure requires further investigation.

The findings suggest that this structure may correspond not only to human creative processes but also to broader phenomena such as self-organization and individuation. This breadth of scope is still under investigation and discussion.

There are things that are confirmed, things that are promising but still under verification, and things that remain hypotheses. In this document, we have distinguished the temperature of each claim. Rather than hiding what is not yet confirmed, we believe that disclosing the current state of evidence is the honest way to present this model.